

FLORIDA RULES OF CIVIL PROCEDURE

FORM 1.947(b). ANSWER—RESIDENTIAL EVICTION

1. The defendant answers the complaint as follows: (Check ONLY 1 a. or b.)

a. ☒ Defendant generally denies each statement of the complaint.

b. ☐ Defendant admits that all the statements of the complaint are true EXCEPT:

(i) ☒ The following statement(s) in paragraph(s) I (1) of the complaint is/are false. Please explain: There was traffic coming in and out at hours during night but it has been resolved after receiving the written complaint. The person or persons that were coming have not been coming after being notified. The report of selling drugs is not correct to my knowledge.

(ii) ☐ I do not know whether the information in paragraph(s) _____ of the complaint is/are true or false, so I am denying them. I understand the intimidation was a result of loud music.

2. If you write down any defense other than payment of rent, then you must take one of the following steps:

a. ☒ If you agree with the landlord about the rent owed, then you must pay the rent owed into the court registry when you file this response. no demonstration of being unwilling to correct problem.

b. ☐ If you disagree with the landlord about the rent owed for any reason, then you must check box 3(b) below and describe with detail why you disagree. I have attempted numerous times to pay rent but they discontinued the acceptance of monies from me.

c. ☐ You MUST pay the clerk of court the rent each time it becomes due until the lawsuit is over.

If you fail to follow these instructions, then you will lose your defenses. You will not have a hearing in your case and you may be evicted without a court date.

3. The defendant sets forth the following defenses to the complaint: (Check ONLY the defenses that apply, and state brief facts to support each checked defense.)

a. _____ The landlord did not make repairs, and I withheld my rent after sending written notice to the landlord. (Attach a copy of the written notice to the landlord.) Please explain: _____

b. _____ I do not owe the total amount of rent or ongoing amount of rent the landlord claims I owe. I am also asking this court to determine the amount of rent that must be deposited into the court registry and requesting a hearing. **(Motion to Determine Rent.)** Please explain: _____

c. ☒ I attempted/offered to pay all the rent due before the notice to pay rent expired, but the landlord did not accept the rent payment. Please explain: The bar code that I was using would not work and I called the office after attempting to pay five times. The owner spoke to me and said he did not want the rent money. He wants me to sell the mobile home.

d. _____ I paid the rent demanded by the landlord in the notice to pay rent. Please explain: _____

e. _____ The landlord waived, changed, or canceled the notice that required me to move out of the residence. Please explain: _____

f. _____ The landlord filed the eviction in retaliation against me. For example, the tenant has complained to a governmental agency charged with responsibility for enforcement of building, housing, or health codes of a suspected violation, or tenant has complained directly to the landlord. Please explain: _____

g. _____ The landlord filed the eviction in violation of the Federal Fair Housing Act and/or the Florida Fair Housing Act. Please explain: _____

h. _____ The landlord accepted rent from me after sending me the notice to terminate. Please explain: _____

i. ☒ I already corrected the violations claimed by the landlord on the notice to terminate. Please explain: The violation of traffic was corrected before the notice. I do not understand the accusation of selling drugs. I asked the owner if he had proof of the incident or if this was "hearsay."

j. _____ The landlord is not the owner of the property where I live. Please explain: _____

I own the mobile home and was told by the person who sold to me that the title was at the park office. I have had conversation with Desmond and he denies having title but wants me to just sell with Bill of Sale and he would supply a title to purchaser. That must be his common practice.

k. _____ I did not receive the notice to terminate or the notice was legally incorrect. Please explain: _____

l. _____ Other defenses. Please explain: _____

4. **You have a constitutional right to request a trial by a jury of your peers instead of a judge. However, there are some things you should know about this right:**

a. You may have waived this right in your lease, so review it carefully before requesting a jury trial.

b. If you want a jury trial, you should request it in writing when you file your answer or you may waive your right to a jury trial.

c. Jury trials are not simple to conduct. You will bear some responsibility in the process and, if you are unprepared, it may be difficult to represent yourself in a jury trial. Additionally, once you request a jury trial, if

you change your mind and you want the judge to decide your case, the landlord will need to agree.

d. If you have questions about whether to request a jury trial, you should speak with an attorney.

5. Select whether you want to request a jury trial: (Check only one.)

☒ I want a judge to decide my case.

☐ I want a jury to decide my case.

All of the statements made above are true to the best of my knowledge and belief.

Signature: Cheryl Dotson

Printed Name: Cheryl Dotson

Date: 5/22/26

Address: 3928 Argyle St. Zephyrhills FL

Telephone Number: 813 778-7300

E-mail Address: Cheryl dotson ST @

hotmail.com

NOTE: Each defendant named in the complaint for whom this answer is filed must sign this answer unless the defendant's attorney signs.

Effective July 1, 2024.